the old social order which is to be condemned because it is based on social iniquity, capitalist exploitation, military imperialism and on the suppression of the three-fourths if not of nine-tenths of the population of the world. Against this odious state of things which is "crime in permanence", it is our duty to act with the greatest possible strength and without delay. If we do not do so it will mean the end of society."

M. Rolland then referred to his role in the World Congress of all political parties against War and Fascism, which was held in Amsterdam in 1932 and in the permanent Committees appointed by that Congress. "I still believe that there is in non-violence a strong, though latent revolutionary power which can and ought to be used e.g. by refusal of service by general strikes in armament industries etc."

Our conversation did not end without a discussion of the much apprehended and much-talked of war in Europe. "For suppressed peoples and nationalists", I remarked, "war is not an unmixed evil". "But for Europe, war will be the greatest disaster", said he, "it may even mean the end of civilisation. And for Russia, peace is absolutely necessary, if she is to complete her programme of social reconstruction".

Before I took leave of my host, I expressed my deep gratitude for his kindness and my great satisfaction at what he had conveyed to me. I valued so greatly his sympathy for India and her cause that it had filled me with anxiety and fear whenever I had tried to imagine what his reaction would be towards the latest developments in the Indian situation. And I returned to Geneva a happy man.